

APOLLO 8

Manned lunar orbiter

NASA's Apollo 8 mission was a dress-rehearsal for landing humans on the Moon. Its crew comprised three astronauts: Frank Borman, James Lovell, and William Anders. The team were the first humans to leave Earth's orbit, and spent three days circling the Moon. They saw the far side of the Moon and took 700 images of its surface.

DATA FILE



SIZE: Command/service module – 11 m (36 ft) long



DATE OF LAUNCH: 21 December 1968



MISSION DURATION: 6 days, 3 hours, 40 minutes



SPACE AGENCY: NASA

The Apollo 8 crew were the **first to see an "Earthrise"** above the Moon.

The service module contained oxygen and hydrogen to generate electricity, along with fuel

The rocket engine was used to place the spacecraft into lunar orbit, and, later, to propel it back towards Earth



Apollo 8 crew (left to right): James Lovell, William Anders, and Frank Borman